

Jane Doe

against example subfield, at career year 6

Jane Doe began a tenure-line appointment at University of X in 2015, which makes this career year 1. The comparison is made at year 6.

The cohort is 0 people, each estimated to have begun a first independent faculty appointment between 2008 and 2018 in example subfield. Jane Doe is not among them.

These numbers describe what a group of people did. They are not a standard, nobody in the cohort agreed to be measured, and no part of this says what any one career should look like.

What this does not tell you

Teaching, mentoring, service, funding, software, datasets, and public scholarship do not appear in OpenAlex, and they are a large part of the job. A publication record is not a person.

Citations are shown and not compared. The cohort's window papers are years older than the subject's, and citations accumulate with time, so placing one count against the other would measure the calendar.

Career start is inferred from publication patterns, not from HR records. For the subject it is supplied; for the cohort it is estimated, and the people it could not be estimated for were dropped rather than guessed at.

OpenAlex splits some people across profiles and merges others with namesakes. The cohort keeps only the people it could identify confidently, which tilts it slightly toward distinctive names.

Journal impact is a property of a journal, not of a paper in it. Venue quartiles are computed inside this cohort's own venue list because citation cultures differ enormously between subfields.

These are descriptive ranges of what a group of people did. A department that reads the median as something everyone must reach has misread this document.